

DATA VISUALIZATION & STORYTELLING

Sample Superstore — turning charts into a business story

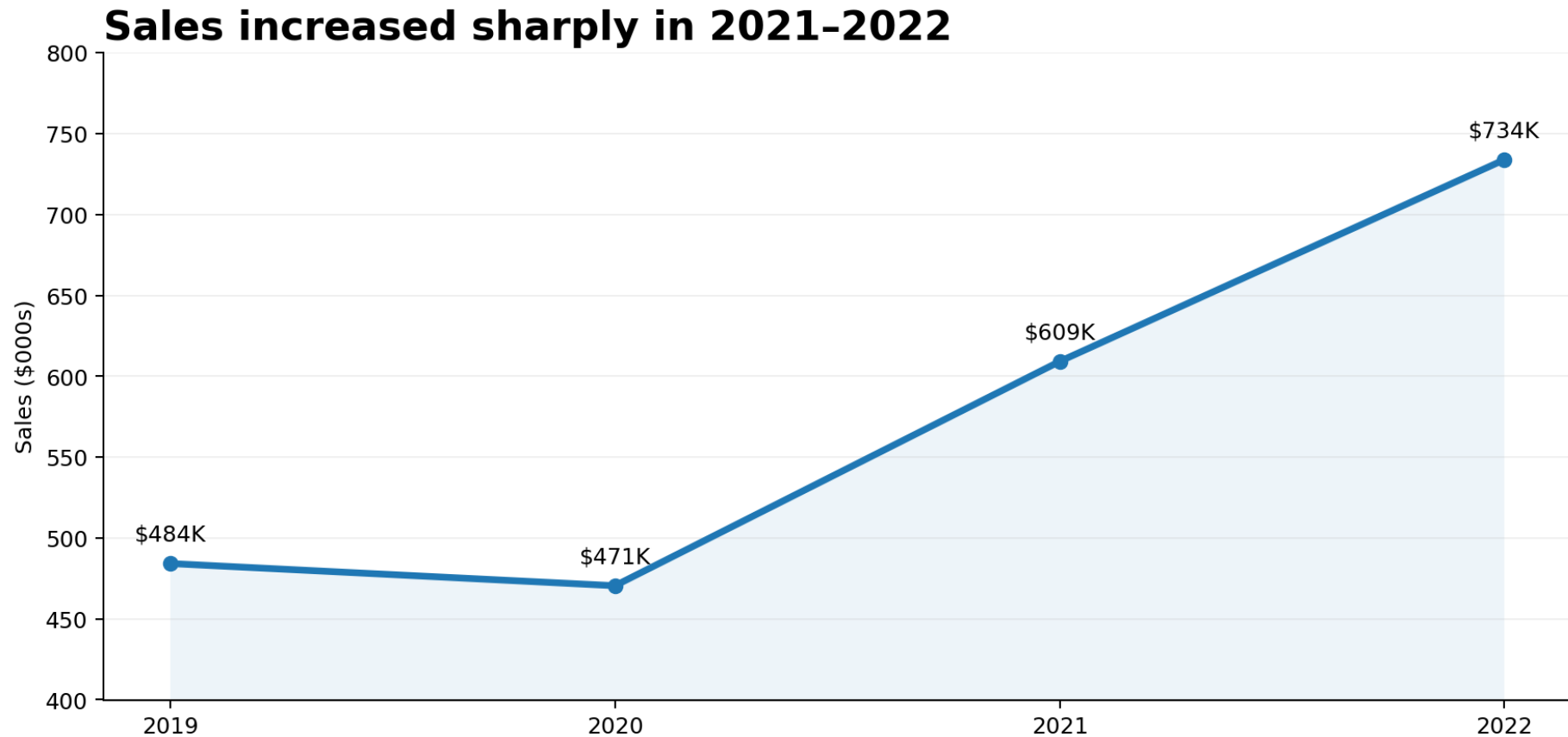
CENTRAL BUSINESS QUESTION

Why is strong sales growth not translating into equally strong profit?

TOTAL SALES	TOTAL PROFIT	PROFIT MARGIN
\$2.30M	\$286K	12.5%

1. Context — sales are growing

Sales rose from about \$484K in 2019 to \$734K in 2022.

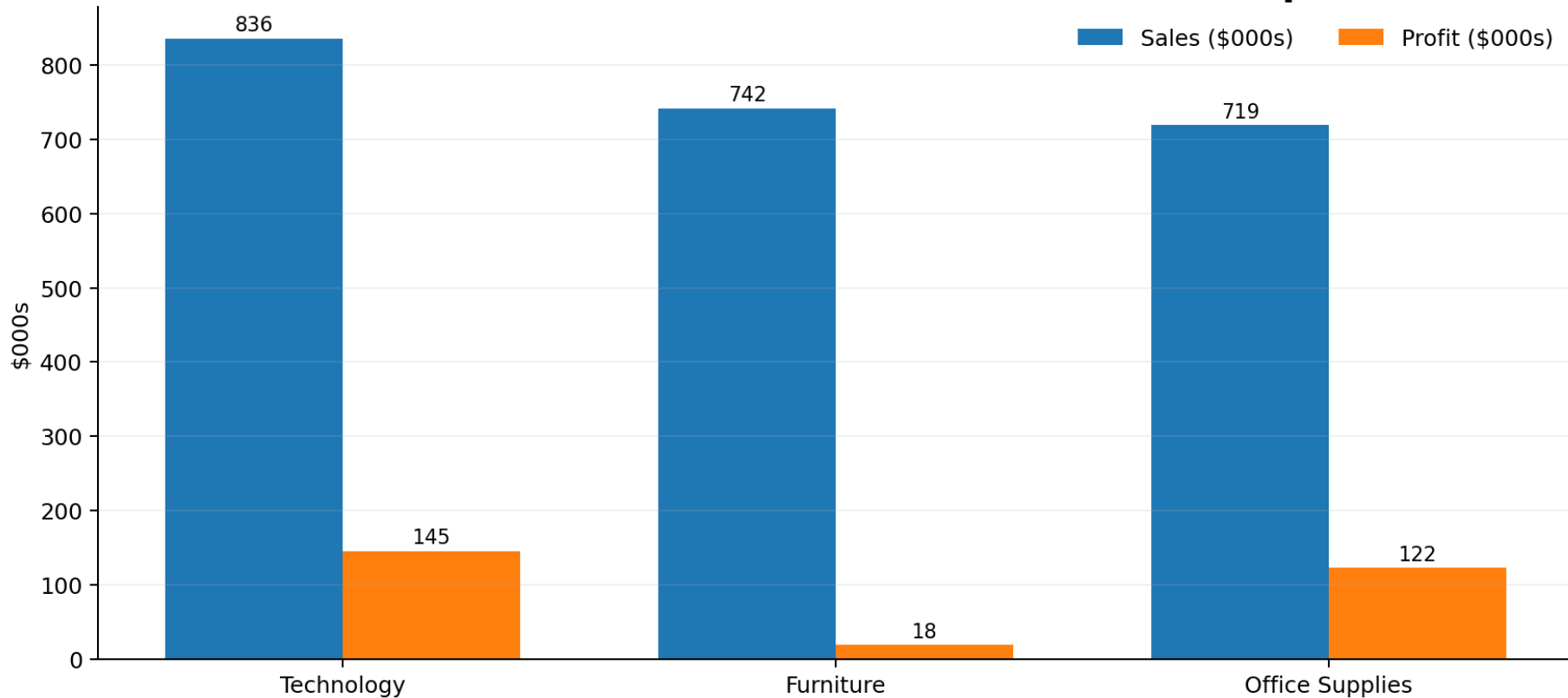


TAKEAWAY | Sales growth is healthy; the business should focus on where sales are least profitable.

2. Problem — revenue and profit tell different stories

Furniture generates about \$742K in sales but only about \$18K in profit.

Furniture sells well, but converts far less revenue into profit

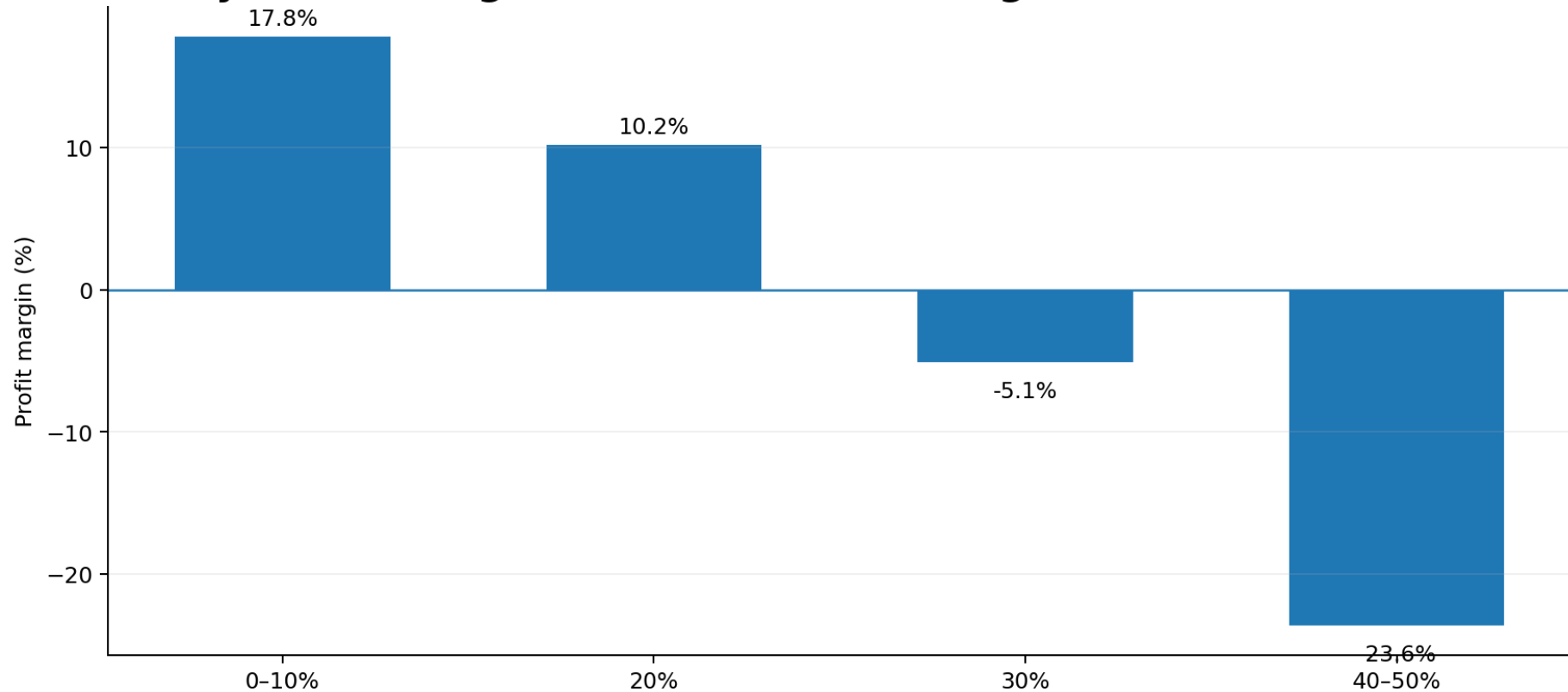


TAKEAWAY | Furniture is the clearest gap: high revenue does not mean healthy profitability.

3. Evidence — discounting is a margin lever

The summarized discount bands show margin weakening as discounts deepen, turning negative at 30%+.

Heavy discounting is associated with margin erosion

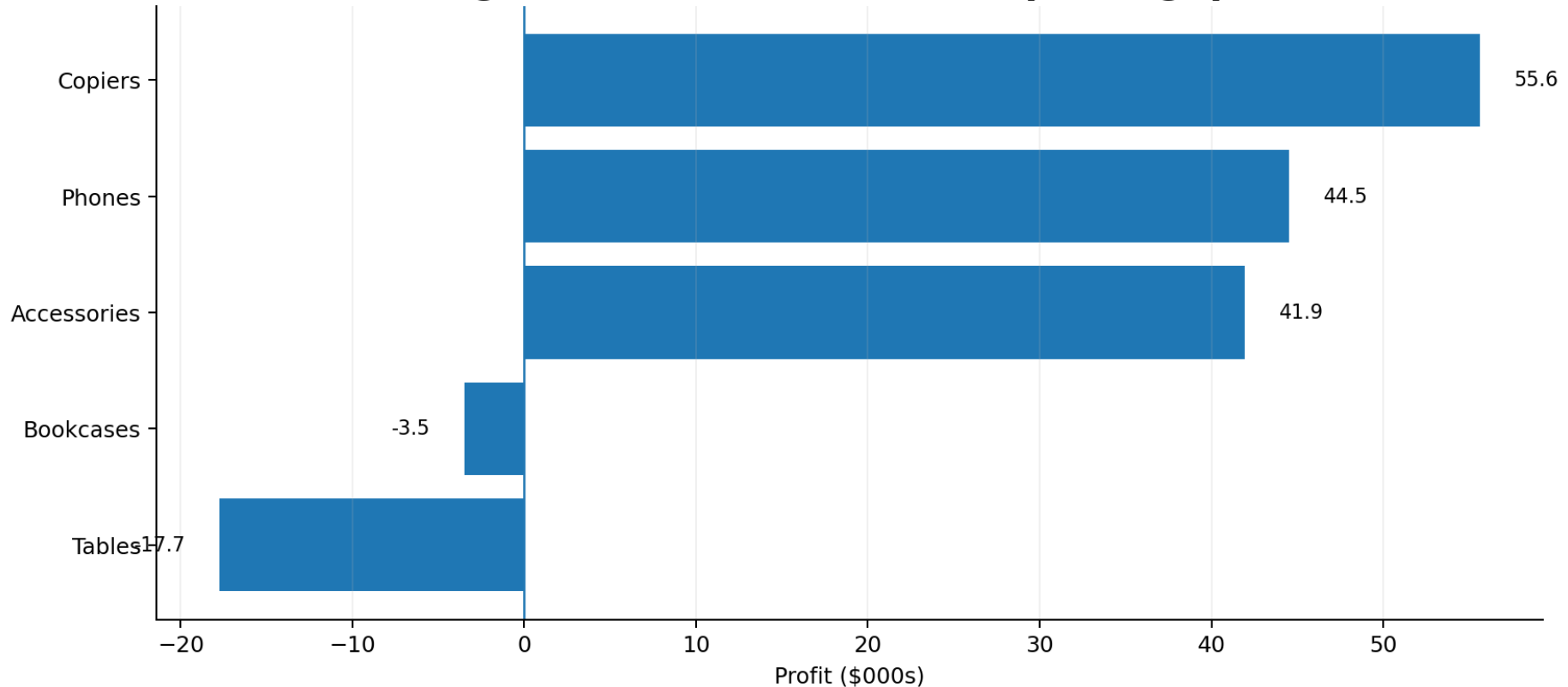


TAKEAWAY | Use discounts selectively — especially on low-margin Furniture items.

4. Evidence — a few sub-categories drive the gap

Copiers, Phones and Accessories are strong profit contributors; Tables is a visible loss-maker.

A few sub-categories create most of the profit gap



TAKEAWAY | Protect high-profit sub-categories and fix loss-making ones before chasing more volume.

5. Recommendation — protect margin while keeping growth

1. **Reduce blanket discounts:** set approval thresholds for discounts above 20%, especially in Furniture.
2. **Fix loss-making products:** review pricing, supplier cost and promotion strategy for Tables and Bookcases.
3. **Scale profitable demand:** prioritize Technology and high-margin sub-categories in campaigns and sales focus.

STORY IN ONE LINE | Demand is growing — the next growth opportunity is better-quality revenue, not simply more revenue.

Source: Tableau Sample Superstore sample dataset. Figures are rounded for presentation readability.